6

WAR AND TERROR

DESTRUCTION IN BAMIYAN AND THE AFTERMATH OF 9/11

'It is the blackest day in the history of civilisation when this 2000-years old world heritage is being destroyed by the so-called people who parade as the protectors of Islam.'

Najma Heptullah, BJP MP in Rajya Sabha, March 2001 on the destruction of the Buddhas in Bamiyan.[1]

'The Taliban is a creature of Pakistan, and now Pakistan is in danger of becoming a creature of the Taliban.'

Jaswant Singh, former External Affairs and Defence Minister of India[2]

'Pakistan must understand that there is a limit to the patience of the people of India.'

Atal Bihari Vajpayee, PM of India in a letter to US President George W Bush in the wake of 9/11 and the attack on the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly that killed 38 people on 1 October 2001[3]

An overflowing 'cup of evil'

When tanks, anti-aircraft guns, and artillery shells failed to make an impact, truckloads of dynamite were drilled in to demolish the world's tallest Buddha statues.[4] Carved in the sandstone cliffs of the central Afghan province of Bamiyan, the statues were pre-Islamic cultural heritage, and were too strong to destroy with a few bombs. But such was the Taliban's determination to end